

# SIMATS ENGINEERING (SAVEETHA SCHOOL OF ENGINEERING)

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

## ASSESSMENT TOOL 1 – Coding Challenge Task

|                  |                                                                              |               |                                           |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Course Code:     | CSA06                                                                        | Course Title: | Design and Analysis of Algorithms         |
| CO Assessed:     | CO4: Articulation (BL4, BL5)                                                 | Assessment:   | Assessment Tool 1 – Coding Challenge Task |
| Weightage:       | 40% of CIA                                                                   | Total Marks:  | 100                                       |
| CO4 Statement:   | Solve optimization problems using dynamic programming and greedy strategies. |               |                                           |
| Student Name:    | A.Ansuha                                                                     | Reg. No.:     | 192472083                                 |
| Section / Batch: | CSE - AI                                                                     | Date:         | 19-08-26                                  |

### Instructions to Students

- Answer the following question. Total Marks: 100.
- Carefully analyze the given questions.
- Write clear code for the given problem.
- Analyze the Time complexity and Space complexity of your code using dynamic programming and greedy strategies

| Question Type         | Focus Area                                                                                      | Questions |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Coding Challenge Task | Focus on Code and analyze optimization problems using dynamic programming and greedy strategies | Q1        |

### SECTION A – Coding Challenge Task

#### Q3. Traveling Salesman Problem (TSP)

A delivery agent must visit multiple cities exactly once and return to the starting location. The travel costs between each pair of cities are given in a matrix. The goal is to determine the most cost-efficient route that minimizes total travel cost. Use Dynamic Programming (Held-Karp method) to solve the problem efficiently.

Sample Input:

n = 4

Cost =

0 10 15 20

10 0 35 25

15 35 0 30

20 25 30 0

Expected Output:

Minimum Cost = 80

## Q3. Traveling Salesman Problem (TSP) – Dynamic Programming

### 1. Problem Understanding

The Traveling Salesman Problem (TSP) requires a delivery agent to:

- Start from a city.
- Visit every city exactly once.
- Return to the starting city.
- Minimize the total travel cost.

For the given problem, the Held-Karp Dynamic Programming method is used because it avoids checking every possible permutation independently.

### 2. Objective

1. To find the minimum-cost route for a delivery agent to visit all cities exactly once and return to the starting city.
2. To solve the Traveling Salesman Problem using Dynamic Programming (Held-Karp method).
3. To reduce the computational cost compared with the brute-force approach.
4. To analyze the time and space complexity of the Dynamic Programming approach.
5. To compare the Dynamic Programming solution with a Greedy strategy.

### 3. Given Input

$n = 4$

Cost =

|    |    |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|
| 0  | 10 | 15 | 20 |
| 10 | 0  | 35 | 25 |
| 15 | 35 | 0  | 30 |
| 20 | 25 | 30 | 0  |

### 4. Dynamic Programming Approach

**Define:**

$dp[mask][i]$  = minimum cost to visit all cities represented by mask  
and finish at city  $i$

where mask represents the set of cities already visited.

For example: mask = 0111

means cities 0, 1, 2 have been visited.

The recurrence is:  $dp[mask][i] = \min(dp[mask \text{ without } i][j] + cost[j][i])$

where j is any previously visited city.

Finally, after visiting all cities, return to city 0:

Answer =  $\min(dp[all\_cities][i] + cost[i][0])$

## 5. Algorithm – Dynamic Programming (Held-Karp)

Step 1: Read the number of cities n and the cost matrix.

Step 2: Create a DP table  $dp[mask][i]$ , where mask represents the visited cities and i is the current city.

Step 3: Initialize  $dp[1][0] = 0$  because the journey starts from city 0.

Step 4: For every visited set, try moving from the current city to every unvisited city.

Step 5: Update the minimum cost:

$$dp[new\_mask][next] = \min(dp[new\_mask][next], dp[mask][current] + cost[current][next])$$

Step 6: After visiting all cities, add the cost of returning from the last city to city 0.

Step 7: Find the minimum among all possible final cities.

Step 8: Display the minimum travel cost.

## Algorithm – Greedy Strategy

Step 1: Start from city 0.

Step 2: Mark the starting city as visited.

Step 3: Select the nearest unvisited city.

Step 4: Move to that city and add its travel cost.

Step 5: Repeat until all cities are visited.

Step 6: Return to the starting city.

Step 7: Display the total travel cost.

## 6. Pseudocode

SET  $dp[mask][city] = INF$

SET  $dp[1][0] = 0$

FOR each mask

    FOR each current city i

        FOR each next city j

            IF city j is not visited

                UPDATE  $dp[mask + j][j]$

                USING  $dp[mask][i] + cost[i][j]$

ANSWER = minimum  $dp[all][i] + cost[i][0]$

PRINT ANSWER

## 7. Python Code

```
CO4 - AT1 - DAA.py - C:/Users/kittu/Downloads/CO4 - AT1 - DAA.py (3.14.0b4)
File Edit Format Run Options Window Help

def tsp(cost):
    n = len(cost)
    INF = float('inf')

    # dp[mask][i] = minimum cost to visit cities in mask
    # and end at city i
    dp = [[INF] * n for _ in range(1 << n)]

    # Start from city 0
    dp[1][0] = 0

    for mask in range(1 << n):
        for current in range(n):

            if dp[mask][current] == INF:
                continue

            # Try visiting an unvisited city
            for next_city in range(n):

                if mask & (1 << next_city) == 0:

                    new_mask = mask | (1 << next_city)

                    dp[new_mask][next_city] = min(
                        dp[new_mask][next_city],
                        dp[mask][current] + cost[current][next_city]
                    )

    # All cities visited
    all_cities = (1 << n) - 1

    # Return to starting city
    answer = INF

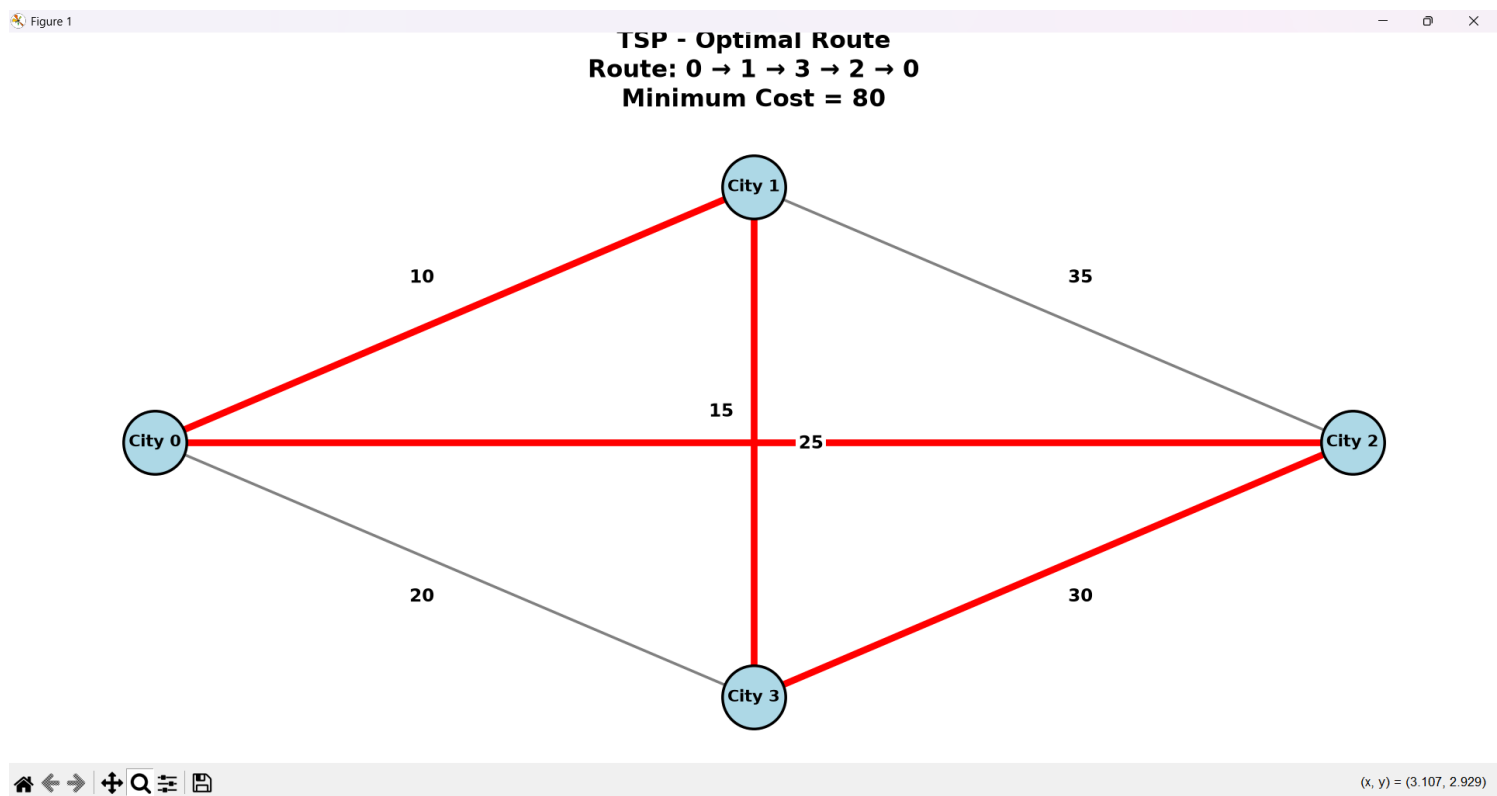
    for city in range(1, n):
        answer = min(
            answer,
            dp[all_cities][city] + cost[city][0]
        )

    return answer

# Input
n = 4
```

## 7. Output

```
IDLE Shell 3.14.0b4
File Edit Shell Debug Options Window Help
Python 3.14.0b4 (tags/v3.14.0b4:7ec1fab, Jul 8 2025, 12:39:48) [MSC v.1944 64 bit (AMD64)] on win32
Enter "help" below or click "Help" above for more information.
>>>
===== RESTART: C:/Users/kittu/Downloads/CO4 - AT1 - DAA.py =====
Minimum Cost = 80
>>>
```



One optimal route is: 0 → 1 → 3 → 2 → 0  
Cost: 10 + 15 + 30 + 25 = 80

## 8. Time Complexity – Dynamic Programming

There are:  $2^n$   
possible subsets of cities.

For every subset, we consider up to  $n$  current cities and  $n$  next cities.

Therefore: Time Complexity =  $O(n^2 \times 2^n)$

### Space Complexity

The DP table contains:

$2^n \times n$  states.

Therefore: Space Complexity =  $O(n \times 2^n)$

This is much better than checking all possible routes using brute force.

### Brute Force:

Time =  $O(n!)$

Space =  $O(n)$

Held-Karp DP:

Time =  $O(n^2 \times 2^n)$

Space =  $O(n \times 2^n)$

| Approach     | Time Complexity     | Space Complexity  | Optimal? |
|--------------|---------------------|-------------------|----------|
| Held-Karp DP | $O(n^2 \times 2^n)$ | $O(n \times 2^n)$ | Yes      |

## 9.Final Conclusion

For the given TSP problem, Dynamic Programming using the Held-Karp method is the appropriate algorithm because it guarantees the optimal minimum-cost route while significantly reducing the complexity compared with brute force.

Minimum Cost = 80

Optimal Route =  $0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 0$

Time Complexity =  $O(n^2 \times 2^n)$

Space Complexity =  $O(n \times 2^n)$

## 10.Manual Solution – TSP Using Dynamic Programming

### Given Cost Matrix

|   | 0  | 1  | 2  | 3  |
|---|----|----|----|----|
| 0 | 0  | 10 | 15 | 20 |
| 1 | 10 | 0  | 35 | 25 |
| 2 | 15 | 35 | 0  | 30 |
| 3 | 20 | 25 | 30 | 0  |

We start from City 0.

#### Step 1: List Possible Routes

Since City 0 is fixed as the starting city, the remaining cities are:

1, 2, 3

There are:

$$3! = 6$$

possible routes.

#### Step 2: Calculate Each Route Cost

**Route 1:**  $0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 0$

$$= 10 + 35 + 30 + 20$$

$$= 95$$

**Route 2:**  $0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 0$

$$= 10 + 25 + 30 + 15$$

$$= 80$$

**Route 3:**  $0 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 0$

$$= 15 + 35 + 25 + 20$$

$$= 95$$

**Route 4:**  $0 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 0$

$$= 15 + 30 + 25 + 10$$

$$= 80$$

**Route 5:**

$$0 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 0$$

$$= 20 + 25 + 35 + 15 = 95$$



**Route 6:**  $0 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 0$   
 $= 20 + 30 + 35 + 10$   
 $= 95$

### Step 3: Compare the Costs

| Route                                                       | Total Cost |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| $0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 0$ | 95         |
| $0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 0$ | 80         |
| $0 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 0$ | 95         |
| $0 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 0$ | 80         |
| $0 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 0$ | 95         |
| $0 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 0$ | 95         |

Therefore:

Minimum Cost = 80

There are two equivalent optimal routes:

$0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 0$

and

$0 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 0$

**Both have cost:  $10 + 25 + 30 + 15 = 80$**

Final Answer

Optimal Route =  $0 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 0$

Minimum Cost = 80

#### Code of Conduct

I \_\_\_\_\_ (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment. I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.

Signature of the Student: A.Anusha

## RUBRICS FOR CALCULATION

### Coding Challenge Task

| Criteria                | Weightage | Level 4 (Exemplary)                                                                       | Level 3 (Proficient)                                      | Level 2 (Developing)                          | Level 1 (Beginning)                              |
|-------------------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Problem Understanding   | 20%       | Clearly understands problem constraints, edge cases, and competitive requirements         | Understands problem with minor gaps in constraints        | Partial understanding; misses key constraints | Misinterprets problem or constraints             |
| Algorithm               | 25%       | Selects optimal algorithm with best time and space complexity for competitive constraints | Uses efficient algorithm with minor scope for improvement | Uses basic/inefficient approach               | No clear algorithmic approach                    |
| Code Implementation     | 20%       | Writes correct, efficient, and clean code that passes all constraints                     | Code works with minor errors or inefficiencies            | Partially correct code; fails for some cases  | Code does not execute or gives incorrect results |
| Competitive Performance | 20%       | Solves problem within time limits and handles large inputs effectively                    | Solves within acceptable time with minor delays           | Struggles with time limits or larger inputs   | Unable to solve within time constraints          |
| Test Case Handling      | 15%       | Handles all test cases including edge and hidden cases                                    | Handles most test cases                                   | Misses important edge cases                   | Fails on multiple test cases                     |

### Marks Evaluation:

| Criteria                  | Wt. | Level 4 – Exemplary | Level 3 – Proficient | Level 2 – Developing | Level 1 – Beginning |
|---------------------------|-----|---------------------|----------------------|----------------------|---------------------|
| Problem Understanding     | 20% |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Algorithm                 | 25% |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Code Implementation       | 20% |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Competitive Performance   | 20% |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| Test Case Handling        | 15% |                     |                      |                      |                     |
| <b>Total Marks (100):</b> |     |                     |                      |                      |                     |

| Faculty In-charge | Course Coordinator | Head of Department |
|-------------------|--------------------|--------------------|
| Name: _____       | Name: _____        | Name: _____        |
| Signature: _____  | Signature: _____   | Signature: _____   |
| Date: _____       | Date: _____        | Date: _____        |